Simon Röhrl

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Google Scholar Profile | github.com/simonroehrl

- Developer/entrepreneur: built shops behind a ∼€50M exit, serving Revid ($10M ARR), built 30+ websites including Suzuki, Aldi, and Mytheresa career sites
- PhD researcher (OTH Regensburg, University of Eastern Finland), 20+ papers; initiated and chairs the international METR (Metrics in Eye Tracking Research) research initiative
- M.Sc. GPA 1.0, best in class
- Bavarian runner-up, 400 m hurdles

Education

03/2025 – present **PhD Computer Science (Doctoral Researcher)**, University of Eastern Finland, Joensuu
Research on eye-tracking metrics and LLM-based tracking of moving web content.

10/2023 – 03/2025 **Master of Applied Research in Engineering Sciences (M.Sc.)**, OTH Regensburg — GPA 1.0 (best in class)
Selected coursework (all 1.0): Deep Learning; Functional Safety & IT Security; Probability, Statistics & Optimization; Digitalization & Ethics; Eye Tracking in Engineering Sciences; Agile Software Development with Scrum; research methods (grant writing, scientific presenting, start-up case study).

10/2019 – 09/2023 **B.Eng. Electrical Engineering & Information Technology**, OTH Regensburg
Dual study programme with OSRAM.

09/2011 – 06/2019 **Abitur**, Johann-Michael-Fischer-Gymnasium Burglengenfeld.

Professional

05/2021 – present **Developer & Entrepreneur** — freelance since 2021, RSites GmbH since 2023 (alone + hiring freelancers)
- 30+ corporate and career websites (frontend and PHP backend, job portals fed by SAP SuccessFactors): Suzuki, Aldi Süd, INNIO, Mytheresa, LKQ Europe, Lürssen, Teledata, Wurzer Umwelt; others incl. Eventim, Akkodis and IG Metall.
- Full Shopify stack for Bears with Benefits (∼€50M exit).
- Built an AI tool that turns Figma designs into frontend modules; sold to an agency for a five-figure sum.
- Founded and runs BlitzFrames, accelerated video rendering infrastructure on a dedicated server fleet with custom browsers for customers incl. Revid ($10M ARR).

10/2023 – present **Research Associate**, OTH Regensburg
- Full-stack eye-tracking web platform; eye-tracker control via WebUSB; open-source Moodle plugin; administration of the research lab infrastructure.
- Eye-tracking studies with industry partners WaveEye and Optomech; teaching in software engineering education; grant writing.

07/2019 – 01/2022 **Dual Study** (Elektroniker & B.Eng. Elektrotechnik), OSRAM Opto Semiconductors GmbH, Regensburg

Research

- **Chair of the METR workshop** (metr2026.com) at ETRA 2026, the leading eye-tracking conference: initiated it, ran the peer review and led the programme committee; built a community of ∼68 researchers working on metric standardisation.
- **20+ peer-reviewed papers** on eye tracking, web technologies and AI, incl. first-author papers at ETRA and in IEEE Access.
- **International network:** collaborators at Harvard, Utrecht, Lund, Clemson and Nebraska; research stays in Finland, Morocco, the Netherlands and Spain.
- **Funding and leadership:** co-led funding applications and an institutional cooperation agreement with Abertay University (Scotland); supervised 10+ Bachelor's, Master's and project theses.

Tech

- **Languages:** TypeScript, Python, PHP, SQL, Bash
- **Web (full stack):** React, Node.js, WordPress, TYPO3, Shopify, CSS, Remotion
- **AI & agents:** Claude Code, Codex, agentic pipelines (browser automation, research, design to code, language porting)

– **Infrastructure:** Linux, Docker, Hetzner, AWS, GitLab CI/CD, server administration (DNS, mail, monitoring and alerting)

More

– Competitions: several first-place awards and top placements in mathematics contests (Pangea, Landeswettbewerb und Bundeswettbewerb Mathematik, Ostbayerisches ScienceCamp, Fürther Mathematik-Olympiade, Bundeswettbewerb Latein)
– Athletics: current Bavarian vice-champion in the 400 m hurdles (2026); competed at the national championships; two-time Bavarian youth runner-up (400 m, pentathlon) in 2018/19; two-time North Bavarian champion (pentathlon) in 2018/19.
– Languages: native German and fluent English